

Marketplace Fee Transparency Report

Independent analysis of fee transparency across Amazon, Walmart Marketplace, and eBay — April through June 2026.

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Executive Summary

The Seller Transparency Hub analyzed publicly available marketplace fee policies and fee updates across major e-commerce platforms during Q2 2026.

This report focuses on fee transparency, seller cost visibility, and policy changes affecting third-party merchants operating on Amazon, Walmart Marketplace, and eBay.

Key Findings

- Marketplace fee structures remain complex and fragmented.
- Sellers often face difficulty identifying the total cost of selling across platforms.
- Fee updates are frequently announced through multiple channels, creating transparency challenges.
- Greater standardization and public reporting would improve seller decision-making.

Scope of Analysis

Platforms covered

- Amazon
- Walmart Marketplace
- eBay

Data sources

- Official marketplace fee schedules
- Public policy announcements
- Seller-facing documentation
- Archived fee change notices

Reporting period

April 1, 2026 – June 30, 2026

Amazon Marketplace Fee Overview

Amazon continues to utilize a multi-layer fee structure including:

- Referral fees
- Fulfillment fees
- Storage fees
- Additional service fees

Observed transparency challenges

- Multiple fee categories impact total seller cost.
- Fee updates are distributed across different documentation pages.
- Historical fee changes are difficult to track in a centralized location.

Walmart Marketplace Fee Overview

Walmart Marketplace primarily relies on referral fees.

Observations

- Fee schedules are generally simpler than Amazon.
- Fee information is dispersed across multiple support resources.
- Category-specific differences may create uncertainty for new sellers.

eBay Marketplace Fee Overview

eBay maintains a final value fee structure with category-based variations.

Observations

- Fee calculations remain dependent on product category.
- Promotional and optional service fees can affect total seller costs.
- Historical comparison data is not always easily accessible.

Comparative Analysis

Platform	Primary Fee Structure	Transparency Complexity
Amazon	Multi-layer fees	High
Walmart	Referral fees	Medium
eBay	Final value fees	Medium

Amazon exhibits the highest fee complexity due to the number of fee components affecting total seller costs.

Implications for Sellers

Transparent fee information is critical for:

- Product pricing decisions
- Profitability analysis
- Marketplace selection
- Long-term business planning

Improved visibility into fee changes can help sellers better manage operational risk.

Methodology

The Seller Transparency Hub collects and reviews publicly available marketplace documentation.

Data is categorized into:

- Fee schedules
- Policy updates
- Historical fee changes
- Seller appeal information

All information is sourced from publicly available marketplace resources.

About Seller Transparency Hub

Seller Transparency Hub is an independent research initiative focused on marketplace transparency, fee visibility, and seller policy research.

Website: sellertransparency.com

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